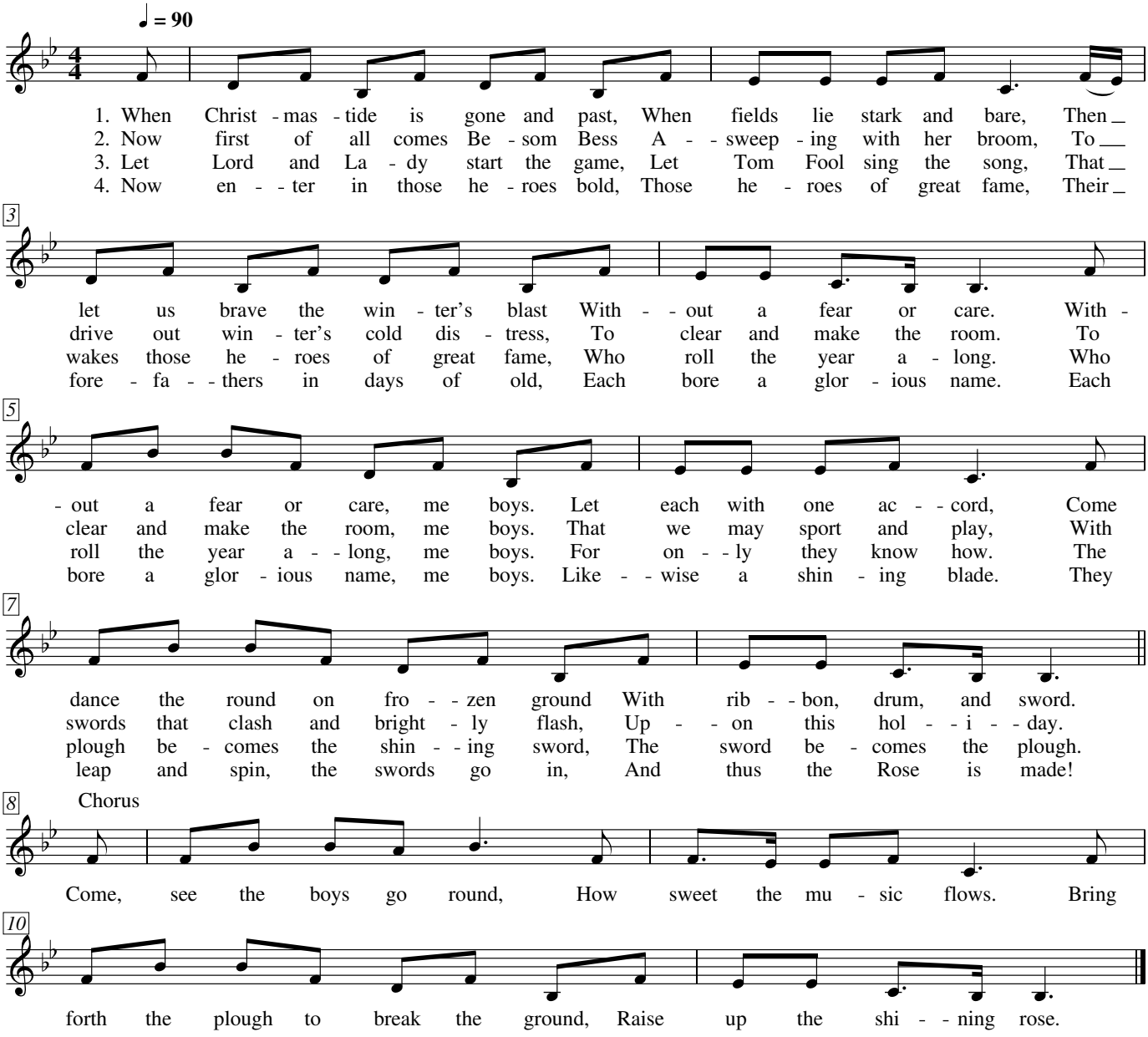
# Come, See the Boys Go Round

Paul Davenport

*Drumming: 4 beat lead in; drumming throughout*

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*Written in 2012 by Yorkshire songwriter, Paul Davenport, to describe the longsword dance performance of the Goathland Plough Stots. The Plough Stots are one of the remaining traditional longsword teams in England. The Stots were originally more of a mumming group who went around with a plough on Plough Monday soliciting money for Epiphany candles for the church and for seeds for crops. The dances are described in Ivor Allsop's "Longsword Dances from Traditional and Manuscript Sources".*

1. When Christmastide is gone and past
   When fields lie stark and bare
   Then let us brave the winter's blast
   Without a fear or care
   Without a fear or care, me boys
   Let each with one accord
   Now dance the round on frozen ground
   With ribbon, drum and sword

   CHORUS
   Come, see the boys go round
   How sweet the music flows
   Bring forth the plough to break the ground
   Raise up the shining Rose

2. Now first of all comes Besom Bess
   A-sweeping with her broom
   To drive out winter's cold distress
   To clear and make the room
   To clear and make the room, me boys
   That we may sport and play
   With swords that clash and brightly flash
   Upon this holiday

3. Let Lord and Lady start the game
   Let Tom Fool sing the song
   That wakes those heroes of great fame
   Who roll the year along
   Who roll the year along, me boys
   For only they know how
   The plough becomes the shining sword
   The sword becomes the plough

4. Now enter in those heroes bold,
   Those heroes of great fame
   Their forefathers in days of old
   Each bore a glorious name
   Each bore a glorious name, me boys
   Likewise a shining blade
   They leap and spin, the swords go in
   And thus the Rose is made!

   The chorus is sung two times after the last verse.